

SAUDI ARABIA

Key Country Details: Saudi Arabia

Detail	Information
Full Name	Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
Short Form	Saudi Arabia
Capital	Riyadh
Region (UN)	Asia-Western Asia
Government Type	Absolute Monarchy
Head of State	King Salman bin Abdulaziz Al Saud
Head of Government	Crown Prince and Prime Minister Mohammed bin Salman
Currency	Saudi Riyal (SAR)
UN Member Since	1945
MUN Standing	Active contributor in OPEC and regional stability debates, often defends conservative social policies and sovereignty-based approaches.

Recommended Books on Saudi Foreign Policy, UN Engagement & Region

1. **"Saudi Arabia and the United States: Birth of a Security Partnership"** – Aaron David Miller
2. **"Saudi Arabia in Transition: Insights on Social, Political, Economic and Religious Change"** – Bernard Haykel et al.
3. **"The Foreign Policies of Middle East States"** – Raymond Hinnebusch & Anoushiravan Ehteshami
4. **"Inside the Kingdom: Kings, Clerics, Modernists, Terrorists, and the Struggle for Saudi Arabia"** – Robert Lacey

5. "Desert Kingdom: How Oil and Water Forged Modern Saudi Arabia" – Toby Craig Jones

Saudi Arabia – UNCSW Engagement

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UNCSW Official Page	https://www.unwomen.org/en/csw	Official documents and reports involving Saudi Arabia
Saudi Arabia National Human Rights Committee	https://www.nhrc.gov.sa	Provides insights into internal gender reforms
Vision 2030 – Women's Rights	https://www.vision2030.gov.sa/v2030/vrps/women/	Key reform agenda on gender equality
UN Women – Saudi Arabia News	https://arabstates.unwomen.org/en/countries/saudi-arabia	UN gender policy updates
World Economic Forum Gender Gap Report	https://www.weforum.org/reports/global-gender-gap-report-2024	Measures Saudi Arabia's gender parity progress
Human Rights Watch – Saudi Arabia	https://www.hrw.org/middle-east/n-africa/saudi-arabia	Independent review of women's rights issues
Amnesty International – Saudi Women	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/middle-east-and-north-africa/saudi-arabia/	Cases involving women activists
UN General Assembly Gender Speeches (KSA)	https://gadebate.un.org	Search Saudi Arabia's speeches on women's rights
CEDAW Reporting – Saudi Arabia	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org	Saudi reports to the Convention on the

		Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women
OECD Gender Review on KSA	https://www.oecd.org/mena/governance/gender-equality.htm	Expert economic impact of gender reforms
Arab Barometer – Saudi Social Attitudes	https://www.arabbarometer.org	Tracks gender-related public opinion
UN Women Data Hub	https://data.unwomen.org	Gender statistics and policy gaps in Saudi Arabia
Saudi Arabia National Transformation Program	https://www.vision2030.gov.sa/v2030/vrps/http/	Women's employment and leadership goals
Report on Women's Driving Law Reforms	https://www.bbc.com/news/world-middle-east-44407049	Key milestone in KSA gender evolution
Freedom House – Women's Rights Score	https://freedomhouse.org	Third-party ranking of gender freedoms in Saudi Arabia

Title	Link	Relevance to UNCSW Agendas
Kingdom Selected President of UN Commission on the Status of Women for 2025	Link	Highlights Saudi Arabia's leadership role in the UNCSW, setting agendas and priorities for women's rights globally.
UN Picks Saudi Arabia to Lead Women's Rights Forum Despite 'Abysmal' Record	Link	Discusses international reactions to Saudi Arabia's chairmanship, reflecting on its domestic women's rights record.
Outrage as Saudi Arabia Chairs U.N. Women's Rights Commission - UN Watch	Link	Critiques the appointment, emphasizing concerns over women's rights violations in Saudi Arabia.

UN Briefings: Saudi Arabia and the UN Commission on the Status of Women	Link	Provides an overview of Saudi Arabia's involvement with the UNCSW and related controversies.
The United Nations in Saudi Arabia	Link	Details the UN's operations in Saudi Arabia, including programs related to gender equality.
UNDP Recognizes UNVs in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia	Link	Showcases volunteer efforts supporting sustainable development and women's empowerment.
UN Environment and Saudi Arabia Sign Deal to Strengthen Environmental Protection	Link	Highlights collaboration on environmental issues, indirectly supporting women's health and livelihoods.
Saudi Arabia	United Nations iLibrary	Link
Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030 and Women's Empowerment	Link	Outlines national plans to enhance women's roles in society, aligning with UNCSW goals.
UN Women Arab States – Saudi Arabia	Link	Provides information on UN Women's initiatives and partnerships in Saudi Arabia.
Saudi Arabia's Report to the CEDAW Committee	Link	Details the country's compliance with the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women.
Human Rights Watch Report on Women's Rights in Saudi Arabia	Link	Analyzes recent reforms and ongoing restrictions affecting women in Saudi Arabia.
Amnesty International Report on Saudi Arabia 2023	Link	Discusses human rights issues, including gender-based discrimination and repression.
UN Special Rapporteur on Violence Against Women – Saudi Arabia Visit Report	Link	Provides findings and recommendations following a country visit focused on violence against women.

Saudi Arabia's National Family Safety Program	Link	Government initiative aimed at protecting families and addressing domestic violence.
World Bank – Women, Business and the Law: Saudi Arabia	Link	Evaluates legal barriers to women's economic participation in Saudi Arabia.
OECD – Gender Equality in Saudi Arabia	Link	Assesses gender equality policies and provides recommendations for improvement.
Saudi Arabia's Efforts to Combat Human Trafficking	Link	Reviews measures taken to prevent human trafficking, including protections for women.
UNHCR – Saudi Arabia's Role in Refugee Support	Link	Highlights contributions to refugee assistance, with implications for displaced women's welfare.
ILO – Saudi Arabia's Labor Reforms and Women's Employment	Link	Discusses labor market changes affecting women's employment opportunities.

Unique Aspects of Saudi Arabia's Engagement with UNCSW:

- **Historic Chairmanship:** Saudi Arabia's election as the chair of the UNCSW in 2025 is a significant moment, as it's the first time a country with such a controversial track record on women's rights has taken on this role. This has ignited a global conversation about the implications of this decision.
- **Vision 2030 Reforms:** Under the Vision 2030 initiative, Saudi Arabia is making strides to boost women's involvement in both the workforce and public life, all while aligning with the goals set by the UNCSW.
- **Legal Developments:** The Personal Status Law introduced in 2022 established some rights for women, yet it still kept parts of the male guardianship system in place. This really shows just how complicated legal reforms can be.
- **International Scrutiny:** Saudi Arabia's involvement in the UNCSW has drawn a lot of international attention to its domestic policies, resulting in growing calls for real reforms in women's rights.

- **Activism and Repression:** The country's involvement with the UNCSW has shed light on the struggles faced by women's rights activists in Saudi Arabia, many of whom endure detention and repression.
- **Global Influence:** Despite facing criticism, Saudi Arabia's role in the UNCSW gives it a chance to shape global conversations about gender equality, making its actions and policies quite impactful on the international stage.

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